

KEY TOPIC 1 CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1945–1963**The Birth of the State of Israel, 1945–1963***British Mandate Collapse, King David Hotel, UN Resolution 181, The 1948 War, The Nakba & The Suez Crisis***HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD • 14 MAY 1948****GPO-D597-087****Proclamation of the State of Israel, Tel Aviv Museum of Art**

Rudi Weissenstein (1910–1969) • David Ben-Gurion, Executive Head of the World Zionist Organisation, reads the Declaration of Independence beneath the portrait of Theodor Herzl on 5 Iyyar 5708. Registered in the State of Israel Government Press Office archive under Accession Shelfmark GPO-D597-087.

HISTORICAL PRIMARY SOURCE**EDEXCEL PAPER 2 MASTER ARCHIVE****PUPIL WORKBOOK & ASSESSMENT****EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY • PAPER 2: CONFLICT IN THE MIDDLE EAST, 1945–1995 • KEY TOPIC 1**

NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY SPECIFICATION • KEY TOPIC 1 CONTENT**OFFICIAL SPECIFICATION CONTENT****1. THE BRITISH WITHDRAWAL & ISRAEL**

- Conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate.
- Key events leading to the end of the British Mandate, partition and the creation of Israel, including the significance of the bombing of the King David Hotel and UN Resolution 181.
- Key events of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49).

2. AFTERMATH OF THE 1948–49 WAR

- Territorial changes and their impact.
- The refugee status of Palestinian Arabs.
- The creation of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) and the Law of Return (1950).
- US aid to Israel.
- Israel's relations with Egypt.

3. INCREASED TENSION, 1955–63

- Nasser and Egypt's leadership of the Arab world.
- The events and significance of Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955 and Sinai in 1956.
- The events and significance of the Suez Crisis (1956), including the formation of the United Arab Republic (UAR) in 1958.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: IMPERIAL PLEDGES, INSURGENCY & PARTITION (1917–1947)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding Key Topic boxes below.

NOV 1917 • The Balfour Declaration & Contradictory British Promises

Key Topic 1.1

British Foreign Secretary Arthur Balfour writes to Lord Rothschild promising British support for the establishment of a "national home for the Jewish people" in Palestine. This directly contradicts Britain's 1915 pledge to Sharif Hussein of Mecca and the secret 1916 Sykes-Picot Agreement dividing the Middle East with France.

JULY 1946 • The Bombing of the King David Hotel, Jerusalem

Key Topic 1.2

Disguised as milkmen, militants from the Zionist paramilitary group Irgun, led by Menachem Begin, detonate 350kg of explosives in the basement of the King David Hotel. The blast collapses the entire south-west wing housing British military headquarters, killing 91 British, Arab, and Jewish staff.

NOV 1947 • UN Resolution 181 (The Palestine Partition Plan)

Key Topic 1.3

The United Nations General Assembly votes 33 to 13 to terminate the British Mandate and partition Palestine into separate Arab and Jewish states, with Jerusalem placed under international United Nations trusteeship. The Jewish Agency accepts; all Arab nations reject the plan, triggering civil war.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: STATEHOOD, THE NAKBA & THE SUEZ CRISIS (1948–1956)

Instructions: Complete sketches and dual-coding annotations for the war of independence, the displacement of Palestinians, and the 1956 Suez Crisis.

MAY 1948 • Declaration of Independence & The 1948–49 Arab-Israeli War

Key Topic 1.3

On 14 May 1948, David Ben-Gurion proclaims the State of Israel as British forces complete their evacuation. The next day, five Arab states (Egypt, Transjordan, Syria, Iraq, Lebanon) invade. Israel survives initial assaults, re-arms during the June UN truce via Czechoslovakia, and signs armistices along the 1949 Green Line.

1948–1950 • The Palestinian Refugee Crisis (Al-Nakba) & Law of Return

Key Topic 1.4

Approximately 700,000 Palestinian Arabs are displaced into permanent exile (Al-Nakba), supported by the newly formed UNRWA in Gaza, the West Bank, Lebanon, and Syria. Simultaneously, Israel passes the 1950 Law of Return, absorbing over 680,000 Holocaust survivors and Mizrahi Jewish refugees from Arab lands.

OCT–NOV 1956 • The Suez Crisis & The Protocol of Sèvres

Key Topic 1.5

Following Nasser's nationalisation of the Suez Canal, Britain, France, and Israel secretly sign the Protocol of Sèvres. Israel invades the Sinai on 29 October; Britain and France intervene to "separate the combatants" and seize the canal. US financial ultimatums force a humiliating Anglo-French withdrawal, leaving UNEF peacekeepers in Sinai.

Why did conflicting British wartime promises make conflict in Palestine inevitable?

Key Topic 1.1: Imperial Origins, Conflicting Promises & Mandate Tensions (1915–1945)

Key Specification Focus: Conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate; contextualised by the McMahon-Hussein Correspondence (1915), the secret Sykes-Picot Agreement (1916), the Balfour Declaration (1917), and the 1939 British White Paper.

1 1915–1916

The McMahon-Hussein Correspondence

- Sherif Hussein of Mecca
- High Commissioner McMahon
- Arab Revolt against Ottomans
- Pledge of Arab independence

FOCUS CLUE

Why did Arabs believe Britain promised them Palestine in 1915?

2 May 1916

The Secret Sykes-Picot Agreement

- Mark Sykes & François Picot
- Secret British-French treaty
- Middle East imperial carve-up
- International administration zone

FOCUS CLUE

Why was the secret Sykes-Picot deal seen as an imperial betrayal?

3 November 1917

The Balfour Declaration

- Foreign Sec Arthur Balfour
- Lord Walter Rothschild
- "National home for Jewish people"
- Safeguard civil & religious rights

FOCUS CLUE

Why was the Balfour Declaration contradictory to McMahon's pledge?

4 1920–1936

The British Mandate & Rising Immigration

- League of Nations Mandate
- 1929 Jaffa & Hebron riots
- 1936–39 Arab Great Revolt
- Haganah Jewish defence militia

FOCUS CLUE

How did rising Jewish immigration spark the 1936 Arab Revolt?

5 1936–1939

The Arab Revolt & The 1939 White Paper

- Colonial Sec Malcolm MacDonald
- 75,000 Jewish entry cap (5 yrs)
- Arab consent for future entry
- Zionist sense of betrayal

FOCUS CLUE

Why did the 1939 White Paper turn Zionists against Britain?

[illegible]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

PFC Guidance: Identify a clear consequence (e.g. Arab sense of betrayal or international legitimisation of a Jewish homeland), cite specific factual detail, and explain its long-term impact on tensions in Palestine.

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT • 8 MARKS

McMahon-Hussein (1915) • Sharif Hussein • Sykes-Picot (1916) • Balfour Declaration (1917) • Arthur Balfour • Lord Rothschild • "national home" • League of Nations Mandate (1922) • Yishuv • Arab Nationalism • Jewish immigration

[illegible]

[illegible]

"Extended responses win Grade 9: deploy precise statistics and sustain your historical argument."

Why did Britain abandon its Mandate in Palestine and hand the problem to the UN?

Key Topic 1.2: The Collapse of the British Mandate & UN Partition (1945–1947)

Key Specification Focus: Conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate; Jewish insurgency (the Irgun and Lehi); the bombing of the King David Hotel (July 1946); British economic and military exhaustion; the SS Exodus affair (1947); and UNSCOP recommendations.

1 1945–1946

Holocaust Survivors & Immigration Caps

- 250,000 Displaced Persons (DPs)
- Foreign Sec Ernest Bevin
- 1,500 monthly entry quota
- Truman calls for 100,000 visas

FOCUS CLUE

Why did Bevin strictly enforce the 1,500 monthly refugee limit?

2 Nov 1945 – 1946

The Jewish Insurgency & Night of the Trains

- United Resistance Movement
- Haganah, Irgun & Lehi alliance
- Night of Trains (153 rail cuts)
- Guerilla raids & oil sabotage

FOCUS CLUE

How did Zionist paramilitaries paralyze British transport networks?

3 22 July 1946

Bombing of the King David Hotel

- Menachem Begin (Irgun commander)
- 350kg explosives in milk churns
- British military & civil HQ
- 91 officials & staff killed

FOCUS CLUE

Why did targeting the King David Hotel prove Palestine was ungovernable?

4 July 1947

The Sergeants Affair & Public Backlash

- Sgts Clifford Martin & Mervyn Paice
- Retaliation for Acre hangings
- Booby-trapped bodies in grove
- UK anti-Jewish riots & outcry

FOCUS CLUE

Why did the hanged sergeants trigger "bring our boys home" demands?

5 Summer–Nov 1947

The SS Exodus & UN Referral

- SS Exodus (4,500 refugees)
- Royal Navy forced German return
- US outrage & loan threats
- UNSCOP recommendation (Feb 1947)

FOCUS CLUE

How did the SS Exodus PR disaster force Britain to surrender the Mandate?

[illegible]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

PFC Guidance: Focus on the 91 deaths, the destruction of British military headquarters, and the hardening of British domestic public opinion demanding troop withdrawal from Palestine.

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT • 8 MARKS

Structure across two distinct analytical aspects: • Destruction of British Military HQ & Security Breakdown • Domestic Economic Exhaustion & Handover to the UN

3. EVALUATIVE SUMMARY: UN REFERRAL

3. EVALUATIVE SUMMARY - ON REFERENCE
Assess why Foreign Secretary Bevin concluded Britain could not reconcile Zionist and Arab demands, forcing the February 1947 handover to UNSCOP.

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

King David Hotel (July 1946) • Irgun • Menachem Begin • 91 casualties • British Military HQ • Secretariat • Clement Attlee • Ernest Bevin • financial cost • 100,000 troops • UNSCOP • February 1947 handover

[illegible]

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.2). In Milestone 2, sketch the shattered south-west wing of the King David Hotel and the barbed wire perimeter around British administrative zones.

11/24

How was the State of Israel established and defended during the 1948–49 War?

Key Topic 1.3: UN Resolution 181, Independence & The 1948–49 War (1947–1949)

Key Specification Focus: UN Resolution 181 (Partition Plan, November 1947); outbreak of civil war; the British evacuation; David Ben-Gurion's declaration of the State of Israel (14 May 1948); invasion by five Arab armies; the UN truces; and the 1949 Armistice Agreements (Green Line).

1 Dec 1947 – May 1948

Communal Civil War & Plan Dalet

- UN Resolution 181 partition (55%/45%)
- Plan Dalet (Plan D offensive)
- Tel Aviv–Jerusalem convoy ambushes
- Deir Yassin massacre & panic
- British military non-intervention

FOCUS CLUE

Why was securing the Tel Aviv–Jerusalem road vital before 14 May?

2 14 May 1948

Proclamation of the State of Israel

- David Ben-Gurion declaration
- Tel Aviv Museum of Art
- Theodor Herzl portrait
- US Truman recognition in 11 mins
- British Mandate expires at midnight

FOCUS CLUE

Why did Ben-Gurion insist on declaring statehood hours before the British left?

3 15 May 1948

Five Arab Armies Invade

- Egypt, Transjordan, Syria, Iraq, Lebanon
- Multi-front coordinated assault
- Glubb Pasha & Arab Legion
- Old City of Jerusalem captured
- Severe Israeli heavy weapons deficit

FOCUS CLUE

Which strategic areas did Transjordan's Arab Legion seize immediately?

4 June–July 1948

The First UN Truce & Czech Arms Resupply

- Count Folke Bernadotte 28-day truce
- Operation Balak Czech arms airlift
- 25,000 rifles & Avia fighter planes
- Unified IDF command established
- Bernadotte assassinated by Lehi

FOCUS CLUE

How did the 4-week UN truce decisively tip military firepower to Israel?

5 Feb–July 1949

Rhodes Armistices & The Green Line

- UN mediator Ralph Bunche
- 1949 Rhodes Armistice Agreements
- Green Line borders (Israel 79%)
- Transjordan annexes West Bank
- Egypt controls Gaza Strip

FOCUS CLUE

How did the 1949 Green Line transform the borders allocated by UN 181?

[illegible]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

PFC Guidance: Detail how the UN vote to partition Palestine granted international legitimacy to the creation of a Jewish state, but provoked immediate violent rejection and civil war by Palestinian Arabs.

Sentence Stems: One consequence of UN Resolution 181 was... Specifically, the UN voted to allocate 55% of Palestine to a Jewish state, which resulted in... Consequently, civil conflict broke out immediately between...

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT • 8 MARKS

You may use the following in your answer: • David Ben-Gurion's Declaration of Independence (14 May 1948) • The first UN truce and Czechoslovakian arms shipments (June 1948) • *You must also use information of your own.*

3. PHASE 3: ISRAELI OFFENSIVES

Detail Operations Dani and Yoav breaking Arab armies, leading to the 1949 Rhodes Armistice Agreements and Green Line.

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

David Ben-Gurion • 14 May 1948 • Tel Aviv Museum • Arab invasion • Egypt, Jordan, Syria, Iraq, Lebanon • Arab Legion • Glubb Pasha • June 1948 truce • Count Folke Bernadotte • Czech arms deal • Operation Dani • Operation Yoav • 1949 Armistices • Green Line

[illegible]

[illegible]

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.3). In Milestones 3 & 4, sketch the UN Partition map divisions and the five Arab invasion routes crossing Israel's borders.

15/24

Why did the aftermath of the 1948–49 War create a permanent refugee crisis and an armed Israeli state?

Key Topic 1.4: The Refugee Crisis (Nakba), Israeli Statehood & Border Friction (1949–1955)

Key Specification Focus: Territorial changes and the refugee status of approximately 700,000 Palestinian Arabs (Al-Nakba); creation and role of **UNRWA**; the development of the State of Israel: the **Law of Return (1950)**; the creation of the **Israeli Defence Forces (IDF)**; the role of **US financial aid**; and **early relations between Israel and its Arab neighbours**.

1 1948–1949

The Palestinian Refugee Flight (Al-Nakba)

- 700,000+ Palestinians displaced
- Contested causes: flight vs expulsion
- Destruction of 400+ Arab villages
- Loss of homes, farmland & property
- Al-Nakba ("The Catastrophe")

FOCUS CLUE

Why is the cause of the 1948 Palestinian refugee exodus still contested?

2 Dec 1949

UN Resolution 194 & Creation of UNRWA

- UN General Assembly Res 194
- Palestinian "Right of Return" principle
- Creation of UNRWA relief agency
- Camps in Gaza, West Bank, Jordan, Lebanon
- Refugees denied resettlement

FOCUS CLUE

Why did Arab states and Israel disagree over UN Resolution 194?

3 July 1950

The Israeli Law of Return & Immigration Boom

- Law of Return enacted (Knesset)
- Automatic citizenship for any Jew
- Holocaust survivors & Mizrahi Jews
- Jewish population doubles in 3 yrs
- Ma'abarot transit tent camps

FOCUS CLUE

How did the Law of Return transform Israel's demographics by 1953?

4 1948–1953

IDF Military Consolidation & US Aid

- Integration of Haganah, Irgun & Lehi
- Universal compulsory military service
- US government grants & soft loans
- American Jewish diaspora fundraising
- Technological & defensive edge

FOCUS CLUE

Why was universal conscription essential for Israel's survival?

5 1949–1954

Border Infiltration & Retaliatory Raids

- Palestinian refugee border crossers
- Stealing crops vs armed sabotage
- IDF Unit 101 (Ariel Sharon)
- 1953 Qibya raid (69 civilians killed)
- Severe international condemnation

FOCUS CLUE

Why did Israeli border crossers trigger Sharon's Unit 101 raid on Qibya?

[illegible]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

PFC Guidance: Focus on the displacement of approximately 700,000 people, the loss of land, exile into squalid refugee camps in Gaza, the West Bank, Lebanon, and Syria, and their denial of a right of return.

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT • 8 MARKS

Structure across two distinct analytical aspects: • Demographic Expansion & Absorbing Holocaust Survivors and Mizrahi Jews • Military Manpower & National Consolidation against Arab Neighbours

1.1 POINT 1: DEMOCRATIC GROWTH
Explain how automatic citizenship for all Jewish immigrants absorbed 700,000 refugees and Holocaust survivors, doubling the population.

Detail how universal conscription into the IDF and establishing kibbutzim along the Green Line fortified frontiers against Arab neighbours.

Assess how the Law fulfilled the founding Zionist mission of a sovereign sanctuary, cementing state legitimacy despite severe rationing.

This was crucial for Israel's development because... • Specifically, the 1950 Law guaranteed... • Consequently, over 700,000 immigrants arrived, which... • Furthermore, this demographic influx enabled the IDF to... • Crucially, placing new arrivals in border kibbutzim ensured... • Ultimately, this transformed Israel from a fragile enclave into...

Law of Return (1950) • David Ben-Gurion • Jewish diaspora • Holocaust survivors • Displaced Persons camps • Mizrahi Jews • ma'abarot (transit camps) • population doubled • IDF universal conscription • kibbutzim border defense

[illegible]

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.4). In Milestone 5, sketch the overcrowded UNRWA refugee tents alongside the cargo ships arriving in Haifa with Jewish immigrants.

19/24

Why did the nationalisation of the Suez Canal trigger an international crisis in 1956?

Key Topic 1.5: Nasser, Border Tension, the Gaza Raid & The Suez Crisis (1955–1963)

Key Specification Focus: Gamal Abdel Nasser and Egypt's leadership of the Arab world; cross-border fedayeen raids; the Israeli raid on Gaza (Feb 1955); the Czech arms deal (1955); the nationalisation of the Suez Canal (July 1956); the secret Protocol of Sèvres; the Sinai campaign; US and Soviet intervention; and the creation of the United Arab Republic (1958).

1 Feb 1955

The Gaza Raid & Escalating Fedayeen Clashes

- President Gamal Abdel Nasser
- IDF Gaza Raid (37 Egyptians killed)
- Egyptian army humiliation
- State-sponsored fedayeen attacks
- Voice of the Arabs radio propaganda

FOCUS CLUE

Why did Ben-Gurion's Gaza raid convince Nasser he needed heavy weapons?

2 Sept 1955

The Czech Arms Deal & Cold War Realignment

- Czech Arms Deal via USSR
- MiG-15 fighters & T-34 tanks
- Western arms monopoly broken
- US cancels Aswan High Dam loans
- Soviet geopolitical entry to Mideast

FOCUS CLUE

Why did the Czech arms deal alarm Britain, France, and Israel?

3 26 July 1956

Nasser Nationalises the Suez Canal

- Alexandria speech ("de Lesseps" codeword)
- Canal revenues fund Aswan Dam
- Anglo-French maritime lifeline seized
- Closure of Straits of Tiran
- PM Anthony Eden vows to remove Nasser

FOCUS CLUE

Why did Britain and France view canal nationalisation as an act of theft?

4 Oct–Nov 1956

The Secret Protocol of Sèvres & Sinai Blitz

- Secret Protocol of Sèvres collusion
- Britain, France & Israel plot
- Operation Kadesh IDF Sinai assault
- Anglo-French ultimatum & Port Said bombs
- Paratroopers at Mitla Pass

FOCUS CLUE

How did the secret Protocol of Sèvres orchestrate a fake pretext for war?

5 Nov 1956 – 1958

US Ultimatum, UNEF & Arab Leadership

- President Eisenhower financial threats
- Sterling run forces UK ceasefire
- UNEF peacekeepers in Sinai
- Nasser emerges as Pan-Arab hero
- United Arab Republic formed (1958)

FOCUS CLUE

Why did the Suez Crisis end in political triumph for Nasser despite military defeat?

[illegible]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

PFC Guidance: Explain how the death of 37 Egyptian soldiers shattered Nasser's illusion of military strength, prompting him to seek Soviet weapons through the 1955 Czech arms deal.

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT • 8 MARKS

Gamal Abdel Nasser • Aswan High Dam • nationalisation • 26 July 1956 • Anthony Eden • Protocol of Sèvres • Operation Musketeer • Sinai Peninsula • Port Said paratroopers • Dwight D. Eisenhower • oil sanctions • run on the pound • UN Emergency Force (UNEF) • United Arab Republic (1958)

[illegible]

[illegible]

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.5). In Milestone 6, sketch the nationalised Suez Canal waterway and the British paratroopers landing at Port Said under US diplomatic pressure.

"Superpower showdown: US financial threats proved the British Empire was officially over." **23/24**

STUDENT ASSESSMENT RECORD • KEY TOPIC 1 TRACKER

Paper 2: Conflict in the Middle East, 1945–1995 • The Creation of the State of Israel (1945–1956)

PUPIL: _____	TARGET GRADE: 	PREDICTED: 	ATTITUDE: 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5
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#	ENQUIRY / LESSON ASSESSMENT	DO NOW (10M)	Q1(A) (4M)	Q1(B) (4M)	EXTENDED (8M)	LESSON TOTAL
1	KT1.1: Imperial Origins & Promises	[/ 10]	[/ 4]	[/ 4]	Q2: [/ 8]	[/ 26]
2	KT1.2: Mandate Collapse & King David	[/ 10]	[/ 4]	[/ 4]	Q3: [/ 8]	[/ 26]
3	KT1.3: UN Res 181 & The 1948–49 War	[/ 10]	[/ 4]	[/ 4]	Q2: [/ 8]	[/ 26]
4	KT1.4: Nakba & The Law of Return	[/ 10]	[/ 4]	[/ 4]	Q3: [/ 8]	[/ 26]
5	KT1.5: Nasser & The 1956 Suez Crisis	[/ 10]	[/ 4]	[/ 4]	Q2: [/ 8]	[/ 26]
KEY TOPIC 1 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS		Do Now: [/ 50]	Q1(a): [/ 20]	Q1(b): [/ 20]	Ext: [/ 40]	[/ 130]

TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK		Effort Grade: []
WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):	EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):	
_____	_____	
_____	_____	
_____	_____	
_____	_____	
Teacher Signature: _____	Date: _____	

INTERACTIVE DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • SCAN FOR INSTANT 20-QUESTION RETRIEVAL PRACTICE		Scan with smartphone camera to open live interactive 20-question self-marking quizzes		
KT 1.1: IMPERIAL PLEDGES  Scan to Quiz Best Score: [/ 20]	KT 1.2: MANDATE COLLAPSE  Scan to Quiz Best Score: [/ 20]	KT 1.3: UN 181 & 1948 WAR  Scan to Quiz Best Score: [/ 20]	KT 1.4: NAKBA & STATEHOOD  Scan to Quiz Best Score: [/ 20]	KT 1.5: NASSER & SUEZ 1956  Scan to Quiz Best Score: [/ 20]